of the economy and the role of government finances and policy in shaping it up.

In each of these postings, I realized the difference economic policies make. While the wrong policies resulted in poor growth, losses in enterprises and a negative contribution to the economy, the right policies generated good turnover and growth in profitability, rising incomes and promotions of workers and a generally positive contribution to the economy.

My interest in pushing for the right economic policies took shape with the 2007–08 budget, where I was able to build in the Vishwakarma contributory pension scheme for unorganized workers, the first co-contribution based pension scheme in the country. This was later adopted nationally as the Swavalamban scheme in the 2010–11 Budget. I also pushed for the creation of a rainy-day fund—Rajasthan Development and Poverty Alleviation Fund—in this budget to park a part of revenue surplus for future use. The Bhamashah scheme, which Rajasthan announced in the 2008–09 budget, was the combination of Aadhaar, Jan-Dhan and IT-accessed delivery of not just government but private services.

Central Stints Whetted My Appetite for Policymaking

I joined the Central government for the first time in the year 2000 as a director in the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA) in the Ministry of Finance. The DEA, by its very nature, dabbled in economic policymaking. Moreover, as the repository of the budgets of the Central government as well as the counterpart of the multilateral and bilateral economic and development agencies of the world, the DEA provided an excellent platform to understand and participate in national economic policymaking.

The opportunity to work as joint secretary in charge of state finances in the Department of Expenditure exposed me to the extremely important issues of the financial management of states, including their financial